

ARKANSAS PUBLIC ACCOUNTABILITY PROJECT (APAP)

Council Briefing Book

Automatic License Plate Reader (ALPR) Program
City of Sherwood, Arkansas

Prepared for the
Mayor and Members of the Sherwood City Council

Public Reference Edition

Publication No. APAP-PUB-2026-003

Version 2.0

July 2026

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Statement of Professional Responsibility

The Arkansas Public Accountability Project (APAP) is committed to objective, evidence-based review of public records. APAP presents facts accurately, distinguishes evidence from opinion, identifies questions before conclusions, corrects errors when identified, and updates publications as additional evidence becomes available.

Editorial Standard

Facts First. Questions Second. Conclusions Last.

Letter to Council

This briefing has been prepared to assist the Mayor and Members of the Sherwood City Council by organizing records obtained through the Arkansas Freedom of Information Act into a concise reference for discussion.

It is intended to support informed oversight and respectful dialogue.

It does not advocate for or against ALPR technology and does not present legal conclusions.

Sherwood ALPR Program Timeline

"A clear understanding of events begins with a clear understanding of when they occurred."

Key Takeaways

- This timeline summarizes significant events documented in records reviewed by APAP.
- It is intended to provide chronological context for Council discussion.
- Dates are based on records received through the Arkansas Freedom of Information Act and other publicly available sources.
- The timeline does not draw conclusions or assign significance beyond the documented events.

Chronology of Documented Events

- 2022 — Earliest documented operational timeframe identified during APAP's review; Sherwood begins implementation of an ALPR program using Flock Safety technology.
- 2022–2025 — Procurement records, contracts, amendments, correspondence, and related administrative records document continuing operation and administration of the program.
- January–June 2025 — Practice and usage reporting period reflected in records reviewed by APAP.
- February 11, 2026 — Publicly available records reviewed by APAP indicate ALPR technology was in operational use during this period.
- March 24, 2026 — Current written Sherwood Police Department ALPR policy adopted.
- July 2026 — APAP receives native electronic audit exports, network audit records, contracts, procurement records, emails, and supporting documentation through Arkansas FOIA requests.
- July 2026 — APAP begins independent statistical verification and evidence cataloging.
- July 15, 2026 — Scheduled meeting between members of the Sherwood City Council and the Chief of Police. This briefing is prepared to support informed discussion.

Records Supporting the Timeline

- Procurement records
- Purchase requests
- Contracts and amendments
- Department policy
- Practice and usage reports
- Audit reports
- Native electronic audit records
- Network audit exports
- Publicly available records
- Arkansas FOIA records

Why This Timeline Matters

Understanding when policies were adopted, records were created, and operational activities occurred provides context for evaluating the documentary record. This timeline is intended solely as a chronological reference and should not be interpreted as a finding concerning compliance or noncompliance with applicable law or policy.

APAP Review Status

- Timeline Research: Complete (based on records currently available).
- Additional Updates: Future editions will incorporate newly received records if they materially affect the chronology.
- Findings Presented: None.

Executive Summary

Sherwood is currently the most complete evidentiary review undertaken by APAP. Records reviewed include procurement documents, contracts, departmental policies, correspondence, audit reports, practice and usage reports, and native electronic audit exports. Statistical verification and comparative statewide review remain in progress.

Key Takeaways

- This packet summarizes factual information documented by the records reviewed by APAP.
- Statements below are limited to information reflected in the documentary record as of the publication date.
- This packet intentionally avoids interpretation or legal conclusions.
- The objective is to provide Council members with a concise factual foundation before presenting discussion questions.

What the Records Show

Based on the records reviewed by APAP as of the publication date, the following information is documented.

Program Administration

The City has maintained written documentation relating to the administration of its ALPR program, including procurement records, contracts, departmental policies, and administrative correspondence.

Department Policy

A written Sherwood Police Department policy governing ALPR operations has been produced in response to Arkansas Freedom of Information Act requests. The policy establishes procedures governing operation of the system and provides the department's written guidance for authorized use.

Procurement Documentation

Procurement records, purchase requests, contractual agreements, and related administrative records have been produced and reviewed. These records document the acquisition and administration of the ALPR program.

Audit Documentation

Audit reports relating to ALPR operations have been produced. Native electronic audit records and network audit records have also been provided, permitting independent review of recorded system activity.

Public Reporting

Practice and usage reports documenting aspects of ALPR operations have been produced. These reports form part of the documentary record reviewed by APAP.

Statistical Review

APAP has begun statistical review of native electronic audit records. Statistical verification remains in progress and is not presented as complete in this Public Reference Edition.

Current Scope

Additional records have been received from other Arkansas jurisdictions. Those records are being reviewed separately and are not relied upon for the factual summaries contained in this briefing.

Summary

As of the publication date, APAP has assembled and organized a substantial documentary record relating to the City's ALPR program. The records include policy documents, procurement records, contracts, correspondence, audit reports, practice and usage reports, and native electronic audit records.

This briefing summarizes those records for discussion purposes and does not present findings regarding compliance or operational effectiveness.

Policy, Governance, and Oversight

"Well-informed questions strengthen public oversight."

Purpose

The following questions are based on records reviewed by APAP as of the publication date. They are intended to encourage informed discussion and are not findings or allegations. Additional records or explanations may address some of these questions.

LRQ-001 — Policy

Can you describe the department's process for reviewing and updating the ALPR policy, including how operational experience, legal developments, and best practices are considered?

LRQ-002 — Policy

How are officers introduced to the policy, and what training or continuing education is provided regarding its requirements?

LRQ-003 — Governance

How are procurement records, contracts, department policy, and administrative correspondence coordinated to ensure the ALPR program continues to operate in accordance with City policy and departmental procedures?

LRQ-004 — Governance

What role do supervisory personnel play in reviewing program administration and ensuring that written policies remain current?

LRQ-005 — Public Accountability

How does the department communicate information about the ALPR program to City leadership and to the public, and are there additional opportunities to improve public understanding of the program?

"Effective oversight depends upon understanding how information is documented, reviewed, and communicated."

Key Takeaways

- Sherwood records reviewed by APAP include audit reports, practice and usage reports, native electronic audit records, and network audit records.
- These records document important aspects of program administration and oversight.
- The following questions are intended to help Council members better understand the department's processes and reporting practices.
- These questions are based on the documentary record and are not intended as findings or allegations.

Council Discussion Questions

CDQ-007

Can you describe the audit process used by the department, including how activities are selected for review, how findings are documented, and how any follow-up actions are tracked?

CDQ-008

How are these electronic records used by supervisors to support accountability, internal review, and program oversight?

CDQ-009

Can you explain how Sherwood evaluates requests for information sharing, what safeguards exist to ensure authorized access, and how those activities are documented?

CDQ-010

How does the department periodically review information-sharing practices to ensure they remain consistent with department policy and applicable law?

CDQ-011

Can you explain how the department determines what information is included in practice and usage reports and whether additional context could assist Council members and the public?

CDQ-012

As the Council considers future oversight of the ALPR program, are there additional reports, metrics, or periodic updates that would support transparency and informed decision-making?

Questions on Transparency, Accountability, and Future Reporting

"Transparency is strengthened when public reporting is understandable, consistent, and supported by documented records."

Key Takeaways

- Sherwood has produced policies, audit reports, practice and usage reports, and related records.
- Transparency benefits from clear reporting and regular communication.
- The following questions focus on future reporting and continued public confidence.
- These questions are based on Sherwood records reviewed by APAP and are not findings or recommendations.

Council Discussion Questions

CDQ-013

How does the department determine which information is included in reports, and are there additional categories that would help Council members and residents better understand program operation?

CDQ-014

How does the department ensure reports remain accurate, understandable, and consistent over time?

CDQ-015

How are significant program changes, policy updates, or operational developments communicated to City leadership?

CDQ-016

Looking ahead, what additional information or periodic reporting would help the Council oversee the program while maintaining public confidence?

CDQ-017

Are there opportunities to strengthen transparency, public education, or reporting practices as the program continues to mature?

Sherwood Documentary Record Summary

Key Takeaways

- Records include policies, contracts, procurement documents, audit reports, usage reports, correspondence, and FOIA responses.
- The record reflects documents received as of the editorial freeze.
- The summary is descriptive and not a statement of findings.

APAP Editorial Standard

No conclusion without supporting documentary evidence.

Documentary Record Referenced

Editorial Purpose

This appendix identifies the documentary record referenced throughout this publication. Collection names are retained to correspond with the underlying documentary record.

Documentary Record Referenced

- Sherwood Administrative Correspondence
- Sherwood Practice & Usage Reports
- Sherwood Audit Reports
- Sherwood Native Electronic Audit Records
- Sherwood Network Audit Records
- Sherwood FOIA Production Records

Editorial Standard

No conclusion without supporting documentary evidence.

Authorities and Record Sources

Purpose

This page identifies the principal legal authorities and documentary sources relied upon in preparing the Public Reference Edition.

Primary Authorities

- Arkansas Code Annotated §§ 12-12-1801 through 12-12-1808
- Arkansas Freedom of Information Act
- Department policies and publicly released records

Record Sources

- FOIA productions received from Sherwood
- Department policies
- Contracts and procurement records
- Audit and usage reports

Closing

This publication is offered for consideration to assist informed public discussion regarding the administration and oversight of automated license plate reader programs. It is intended to encourage thoughtful review of the documentary record while remaining neutral and evidence-based.

Editorial Commitment

- Evidence before conclusions
- Neutral presentation
- Respect for public records
- Professional and factual tone